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Plating apparatus

Abstract

Provided is a technique that can suppress deterioration of plating quality of a substrate due to gas bubbles that remain entirely on a lower surface of a membrane. A plating apparatus **1000** includes a plating tank **10**, a substrate holder **20**, and a membrane module **40**. The membrane module includes a first membrane **41** and a second membrane **42**. The second membrane has an inflow port **42c** for causing a plating solution in a first region **R1** below the second membrane to flow into a second region **R2** above the second membrane and below the first membrane, and an inclined portion **42b** inclining relative to a horizontal direction and inclining so as to be positioned upward as heading from a center side of an anode chamber to an outer edge side of the anode chamber.

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Background/Summary

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) The present invention relates to a plating apparatus.

BACKGROUND ART

(2) Conventionally, there has been known what is called a cup type plating apparatus as a plating apparatus that performs a plating process on a substrate (for example, see PTL 1 and PTL 2). Such a plating apparatus includes a plating tank in which an anode is arranged, and a substrate holder that is arranged above the anode and holds a substrate as a cathode such that a plating surface of the substrate is opposed to the anode. Additionally, such a plating apparatus has a membrane, such as an ion exchange membrane, at a position above the anode and below the substrate inside the plating

tank. This membrane partitions the inside of the plating tank into an anode chamber below the membrane and a cathode chamber above the membrane. The above-described anode is arranged in the anode chamber. During a plating process on the substrate, the substrate is arranged in the cathode chamber.

CITATION LIST

Patent Literature

(3) PTL 1: Japanese Unexamined Patent Application Publication No. 2008-19496 PTL 2: U.S. Pat. No. 6,821,407

SUMMARY OF INVENTION

Technical Problem

(4) In the cup type plating apparatus having the membrane as described above, gas bubbles are possibly generated in the anode chamber for some reason. When the gas bubbles are thus generated in the anode chamber and the gas bubbles remain entirely on a lower surface of the membrane, plating quality of the substrate possibly deteriorates due to the gas bubbles.

(5) The present invention has been made in view of the above, and one of the objects of the present invention is to provide a technique that can suppress deterioration of plating quality of a substrate due to gas bubbles that remain entirely on a lower surface of a membrane.

Solution to Problem

(6) (Aspect 1) To achieve the above-described object, a plating apparatus according to one aspect of the present invention includes a plating tank, a substrate holder, and a membrane module. The plating tank has a bottom wall and an outer peripheral wall extending upward from an outer edge of the bottom wall. The plating tank is configured to accumulate a plating solution and have an anode arranged therein. The substrate holder is arranged above the anode. The substrate holder is configured to hold a substrate as a cathode such that the substrate is opposed to the anode. The membrane module is arranged above the anode and below the substrate. The membrane module includes a first membrane configured to partition an inside of the plating tank into an anode chamber and a cathode chamber below the anode chamber, and a second membrane arranged at a position below the first membrane and above the anode without contacting the first membrane. The second membrane has an inflow port for causing a plating solution in a first region below the second membrane to flow into a second region above the second membrane and below the first membrane, and an inclined portion inclining relative to a horizontal direction and inclining so as to be positioned upward as heading from a center side of the anode chamber to an outer edge side of the anode chamber.

(7) With this aspect, the second membrane as described above is included, and therefore, even when gas bubbles are generated in the anode chamber, the gas bubbles can be moved along the inclined portion of the second membrane using buoyancy and moved to an outer edge of the inclined portion of the second membrane. This can suppress remaining of the gas bubbles generated in the anode chamber entirely on lower surfaces of the first membrane and the second membrane. As a result, deterioration of plating quality of the substrate due to the gas bubbles remaining entirely on the lower surfaces of the first membrane and the second membrane can be suppressed.

(8) (Aspect 2) In the aspect 1 described above, the first membrane may include an extending portion extending in the horizontal direction, and inclined portions extending from the extending portion as a starting point to one side and another side in a direction away from the extending portion and inclining so as to be positioned upward as separating from the extending portion.

(9) (Aspect 3) In the aspect 2 described above, the outer peripheral wall of the plating tank may be provided with a drain port for discharging a plating solution in the cathode chamber from the cathode chamber, and the drain port may be disposed such that a height from the extending portion of the first membrane to the drain port is within 20 mm.

(10) With this aspect, the plating solution in the cathode chamber can be easily discharged from the

cathode chamber.

(11) (Aspect 4) In any one of the aspects 1 to 3 described above, the membrane module may further include a second membrane support member configured to support the second membrane.

(12) (Aspect 5) In any one of the aspects 1 to 4 described above, the membrane module may further include a first membrane support member configured to support the first membrane.

(13) (Aspect 6) In any one of the aspects 1 to 5 described above, the plating apparatus may further include a housing groove formed in the outer peripheral wall of the plating tank so as to be along an outer edge of the inclined portion of the second membrane. The housing groove may be configured to temporarily house gas bubbles moved to the outer edge of the inclined portion of the second membrane and configured to cause a plating solution in the first region and a plating solution in the second region to join together in the housing groove. The plating apparatus may further include an anode chamber discharge port communicating with the housing groove. The anode chamber discharge port is configured to suction the gas bubbles housed in the housing groove together with a plating solution flowing through the housing groove and discharge the gas bubbles and the plating solution to an outside of the plating tank.

(14) With this aspect, the gas bubbles moved to the outer edge of the inclined portion of the second membrane can be temporarily housed in the housing groove, and the housed gas bubbles can be discharged to the outside of the plating tank together with the plating solutions in the first region and the second region via the anode chamber discharge port. This can effectively suppress remaining of the gas bubbles on a lower surface of the second membrane. The gas bubbles are temporarily housed in the housing groove, thereby allowing a plurality of small gas bubbles to be joined and made into large gas bubbles in the housing groove. This can make it easier to discharge the gas bubbles from the anode chamber discharge port.

(15) (Aspect 7) In any one of the aspects 1 to 6 described above, the plating apparatus may further include an ionically resistive element arranged below the substrate in the cathode chamber, and a ring-shaped electric field adjusting block for adjusting an electric field in the cathode chamber. The electric field adjusting block is arranged below the ionically resistive element in the cathode chamber and above the membrane module. The ionically resistive element may be provided with a plurality of through holes disposed so as to pass through a lower surface and an upper surface of the ionically resistive element. The electric field adjusting block may have an inner diameter smaller than an outer diameter of a punching area as an area where the plurality of through holes are disposed in the ionically resistive element.

(16) With this aspect, homogenization of a film thickness of a plating film formed on the substrate can be ensured by the ionically resistive element. Additionally, since the electric field in the cathode chamber can be adjusted by the electric field adjusting block, the homogenization of the film thickness of the plating film can be effectively ensured.

(17) (Aspect 8) In any one of the aspects 1 to 7 described above, the plating apparatus may further include a suppressing member configured to suppress flowing of gas bubbles in the first region into the inflow port.

(18) With this aspect, flowing of the gas bubbles in the first region into the second region from the inflow port can be suppressed.

(19) (Aspect 9) In the aspect 8 described above, the suppressing member may include a suppressing plate arranged below the inflow port of the second membrane and extending in a horizontal direction.

(20) (Aspect 10) In the aspect 8 described above, the suppressing member may include a tubular member arranged below the inflow port of the second membrane and extending in a horizontal direction, and a coupling member configured to couple an inside of the tubular member to the inflow port.

(21) (Aspect 11) In anyone of the aspects 1 to 10 described above, the plating apparatus may further include a plating solution circulation module configured to circulate a plating solution

between the anode chamber and a reservoir tank for anode chamber and circulate a plating solution between the cathode chamber and a reservoir tank for cathode chamber in performing a plating process on the substrate.

(22) (Aspect 12) In the aspect 11 described above, the plating solution circulation module may include a pressure regulating valve arranged in a flow passage configured to circulate a plating solution in the anode chamber to the reservoir tank for anode chamber, the pressure regulating valve being configured to regulate a pressure in the anode chamber such that the pressure in the anode chamber has a value identical to a value of a pressure in the cathode chamber.

(23) With this aspect, the pressure in the anode chamber can be controlled to have the value identical to the value of the pressure in the cathode chamber with a simple configuration.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 is a perspective view illustrating an overall configuration of a plating apparatus according to Embodiment 1.

(2) FIG. 2 is a top view illustrating the overall configuration of the plating apparatus according to Embodiment 1.

(3) FIG. 3 is a drawing schematically illustrating a configuration of a plating module according to Embodiment 1.

(4) FIG. 4 is a schematic diagram for describing details of a supply/drain port according to Embodiment 1.

(5) FIG. 5 is a schematic exploded perspective view of a membrane module according to Embodiment 1.

(6) FIG. 6 is a schematic enlarged cross-sectional view of a part A1 of FIG. 3.

(7) FIG. 7 is a schematic top view of a first membrane according to Embodiment 1.

(8) FIG. 8 is a schematic top view of a first support member according to Embodiment 1.

(9) FIG. 9 is a schematic top view of a second membrane and a second support member according to Embodiment 1.

(10) FIG. 10 is a cross-sectional view schematically illustrating a cross-sectional surface taken along a line B1-B1 of FIG. 9.

(11) FIG. 11 is a schematic top view of a first sealing member according to Embodiment 1.

(12) FIG. 12 is a schematic top view of a second sealing member or a third sealing member according to Embodiment 1.

(13) FIG. 13 is a schematic enlarged cross-sectional view of a part A2 of FIG. 3.

(14) FIG. 14 is a schematic enlarged view of a part A4 of FIG. 13.

(15) FIG. 15 is a cross-sectional view schematically illustrating a peripheral configuration of a second membrane of a plating apparatus according to Embodiment 2.

(16) FIG. 16 is a cross-sectional view schematically illustrating a peripheral configuration of a second membrane of a plating apparatus according to a modification of Embodiment 2.

(17) FIG. 17 is a schematic diagram for describing a plating solution circulation module according to Embodiment 3.

DESCRIPTION OF EMBODIMENTS

Embodiment 1

(18) The following describes Embodiment 1 of the present invention with reference to the drawings. Note that the drawings are schematically illustrated to facilitate understanding of features, and dimensional proportions and the like of each constituent element are not necessarily the same as the actual ones. In some drawings, orthogonal coordinates of X-Y-Z are illustrated for reference. Of the orthogonal coordinates, the Z-direction corresponds to an upper side, and the -Z-

direction corresponds to a lower side (a direction in which gravity acts).

(19) FIG. 1 is a perspective view illustrating the overall configuration of a plating apparatus **1000** of this embodiment. FIG. 2 is a top view illustrating the overall configuration of the plating apparatus **1000** of this embodiment. As illustrated in FIGS. 1 and 2, the plating apparatus **1000** includes load ports **100**, a transfer robot **110**, aligners **120**, pre-wet modules **200**, pre-soak modules **300**, plating modules **400**, cleaning modules **500**, spin rinse dryers **600**, a transfer device **700**, and a control module **800**.

(20) The load port **100** is a module for loading a substrate housed in a cassette, such as a FOUP, (not illustrated) to the plating apparatus **1000** and unloading the substrate from the plating apparatus **1000** to the cassette. While the four load ports **100** are arranged in the horizontal direction in this embodiment, the number of load ports **100** and arrangement of the load ports **100** are arbitrary. The transfer robot **110** is a robot for transferring the substrate that is configured to grip or release the substrate between the load port **100**, the aligner **120**, the pre-wet module **200**, and the spin rinse dryers **600**. The transfer robot **110** and the transfer device **700** can perform delivery and receipt of the substrate via a temporary placement table (not illustrated) to grip or release the substrate between the transfer robot **110** and the transfer device **700**.

(21) The aligner **120** is a module for adjusting a position of an orientation flat, a notch, and the like of the substrate in a predetermined direction. While the two aligners **120** are disposed to be arranged in the horizontal direction in this embodiment, the number of aligners **120** and arrangement of the aligners **120** are arbitrary. The pre-wet module **200** wets a surface to be plated of the substrate before a plating process with a process liquid, such as pure water or deaerated water, to replace air inside a pattern formed on the surface of the substrate with the process liquid. The pre-wet module **200** is configured to perform a pre-wet process to facilitate supplying the plating solution to the inside of the pattern by replacing the process liquid inside the pattern with a plating solution during plating. While the two pre-wet modules **200** are disposed to be arranged in the vertical direction in this embodiment, the number of pre-wet modules **200** and arrangement of the pre-wet modules **200** are arbitrary.

(22) For example, the pre-soak module **300** is configured to remove an oxidized film having a large electrical resistance present on a surface of a seed layer formed on the surface to be plated of the substrate before the plating process by etching with a process liquid, such as sulfuric acid and hydrochloric acid, and perform a pre-soak process that cleans or activates a surface of a plating base layer. While the two pre-soak modules **300** are disposed to be arranged in the vertical direction in this embodiment, the number of pre-soak modules **300** and arrangement of the pre-soak modules **300** are arbitrary. The plating module **400** performs the plating process on the substrate. There are two sets of the 12 plating modules **400** arranged by three in the vertical direction and by four in the horizontal direction, and the total 24 plating modules **400** are disposed in this embodiment, but the number of plating modules **400** and arrangement of the plating modules **400** are arbitrary.

(23) The cleaning module **500** is configured to perform a cleaning process on the substrate to remove the plating solution or the like left on the substrate after the plating process. While the two cleaning modules **500** are disposed to be arranged in the vertical direction in this embodiment, the number of cleaning modules **500** and arrangement of the cleaning modules **500** are arbitrary. The spin rinse dryer **600** is a module for rotating the substrate after the cleaning process at high speed and drying the substrate. While the two spin rinse dryers **600** are disposed to be arranged in the vertical direction in this embodiment, the number of spin rinse dryers **600** and arrangement of the spin rinse dryers **600** are arbitrary. The transfer device **700** is a device for transferring the substrate between the plurality of modules inside the plating apparatus **1000**. The control module **800** is configured to control the plurality of modules in the plating apparatus **1000** and can be configured of, for example, a general computer including input/output interfaces with an operator or a dedicated computer.

(24) An example of a sequence of the plating processes by the plating apparatus **1000** will be described. First, the substrate housed in the cassette is loaded on the load port **100**. Subsequently, the transfer robot **110** grips the substrate from the cassette at the load port **100** and transfers the substrate to the aligners **120**. The aligner **120** adjusts the position of the orientation flat, the notch, or the like of the substrate in the predetermined direction. The transfer robot **110** grips or releases the substrate whose direction is adjusted with the aligners **120** to the pre-wet nodule **200**.

(25) The pre-wet module **200** performs the pre-wet process on the substrate. The transfer device **700** transfers the substrate on which the pre-wet process has been performed to the pre-soak nodule **300**. The pre-soak module **300** performs the pre-soak process on the substrate. The transfer device **700** transfers the substrate on which the pre-soak process has been performed to the plating module **400**. The plating module **400** performs the plating process on the substrate.

(26) The transfer device **700** transfers the substrate on which the plating process has been performed to the cleaning module **500**. The cleaning module **500** performs the cleaning process on the substrate. The transfer device **700** transfers the substrate on which the cleaning process has been performed to the spin rinse dryer **600**. The spin rinse dryer **600** performs the drying process on the substrate. The transfer robot **110** receives the substrate from the spin rinse dryer **600** and transfers the substrate, on which the drying process is performed, to the cassette at the load port **100**. Finally, the cassette housing the substrate is unloaded from the load port **100**.

(27) Note that the configuration of the plating apparatus **1000** described in FIG. 1 and FIG. 2 is merely an example, and the configuration of the plating apparatus **1000** is not limited to the configuration in FIG. 1 and FIG. 2.

(28) Subsequently, the plating modules **400** will be described. Note that since a plurality of the plating modules **400** included in the plating apparatus **1000** according to this embodiment have the identical configuration, one of the plating modules **400** will be described.

(29) FIG. 3 is a drawing schematically illustrating a configuration of one plating module **400** in the plating apparatus **1000** according to this embodiment. The plating apparatus **1000** according to this embodiment is a cup type plating apparatus. The plating module **400** of the plating apparatus **1000** according to this embodiment includes a plating tank **10**, a substrate holder **20**, a rotation mechanism **22**, an elevating mechanism **24**, an electric field adjusting block **30**, and a membrane module **40**.

(30) The plating tank **10** is configured of a container with a bottom having an opening on an upper side. Specifically, the plating tank **10** has a bottom wall **10a** and an outer peripheral wall **10b** extending upward from an outer edge of the bottom wall **10a**, and an upper portion of the outer peripheral wall **10b** is open. Although the shape of the outer peripheral wall **10b** of the plating tank **10** is not particularly limited, the outer peripheral wall **10b** according to this embodiment has a cylindrical shape as an example. In the inside of the plating tank **10**, a plating solution Ps is accumulated. On an outer side of the outer peripheral wall **10b** of the plating tank **10**, an overflow tank **19** for accumulating the plating solution Ps overflowing from an upper end of the outer peripheral wall **10b** is arranged.

(31) It is only necessary for the plating solution Ps to be a solution including ions of a metallic element constituting a plating film, and a specific example of the plating solution Ps is not particularly limited. In this embodiment, a copper plating process is used as an example of the plating process, and a copper sulfate solution is used as an example of the plating solution Ps.

(32) Further, in this embodiment, a predetermined plating additive is included in the plating solution Ps. As a specific example of the predetermined plating additive, in this embodiment, a “nonionic plating additive” is used. The nonionic plating additive means an additive that does not exhibit an ionic character in the plating solution Ps.

(33) In the inside of the plating tank **10**, an anode **13** is arranged. The anode **13** is arranged so as to extend in the horizontal direction. A specific type of the anode **13** is not particularly limited, and it may be an insoluble anode or may be a soluble anode. In this embodiment, an insoluble anode is

used as an example of the anode **13**. A specific type of the insoluble anode is not particularly limited, and platinum, iridium oxide, and the like can be used. Between the anode **13** and a second membrane **42** of the membrane module **40** described later, an anode mask may be arranged.

(34) In a cathode chamber **12** described later inside the plating tank **10**, an ionically resistive element **14** is arranged. Specifically, the ionically resistive element **14** is disposed at a position above the membrane module **40** in the cathode chamber **12** and below a substrate Wf. The ionically resistive element **14** is a member that can be a resistance to movement of ions in the cathode chamber **12** and is disposed to ensure homogenization of an electric field formed between the anode **13** and the substrate Wf.

(35) The ionically resistive element **14** is configured of a plate member having a plurality of through holes **15** disposed so as to pass through to lower surface and an upper surface of the ionically resistive element **14**. The plurality of through holes **15** are disposed at a part of a punching area PA (which is a circular area in top view) of the ionically resistive element **14**. While a specific material of the ionically resistive element **14** is not particularly limited, in this embodiment, a resin, such as polyetheretherketone, is used as an example.

(36) The plating module **400** has the ionically resistive element **14**, thereby ensuring homogenization of a film thickness of a plating film (a plated layer) formed on the substrate Wf.

(37) The electric field adjusting block **30** is configured of a ring-shaped member. The electric field adjusting block **30** is arranged below the ionically resistive element **14** in the cathode chamber **12** and above the membrane module **40**. Specifically, the electric field adjusting block **30** according to this embodiment is arranged on an upper surface of a first support member **43** described later.

(38) As illustrated in FIG. **13** described later, an inner diameter D2 of an inner peripheral wall of the electric field adjusting block **30** is a value smaller than an outer diameter D1 of the punching area PA of the ionically resistive element **14**. In other words, the inner peripheral wall of the electric field adjusting block **30** is positioned on an inner side in the radial direction of the ionically resistive element **14** with respect to the through hole **15** positioned on the outermost side in the radial direction of the ionically resistive element **14**.

(39) The electric field adjusting block **30** has a function of adjusting the electric field in the cathode chamber **12**. Specifically, the electric field adjusting block **30** suppresses concentration of the electric field on an outer edge of the substrate Wf and adjusts the electric field in the cathode chamber **12** such that the film thickness of the plating film formed on the substrate Wf is homogenized. While a specific material of the electric field adjusting block **30** is not particularly limited, in this embodiment, a resin, such as polyetheretherketone, is used as an example.

(40) Since the electric field in the cathode chamber **12** can be adjusted by including the electric field adjusting block **30** in the plating module **400**, the homogenization of the film thickness of the plating film can be effectively ensured.

(41) Note that it is preferred to preliminarily prepare a plurality of kinds of electric field adjusting blocks **30** having different inner diameters D2. In this case, it is only necessary to select an electric field adjusting block **30** having a desired inner diameter D2 among the plurality of kinds of electric field adjusting blocks **30** and to arrange the selected electric field adjusting block **30** in the plating tank **10**.

(42) The ionically resistive element **14** or the electric field adjusting block **30** described above are not essential members in this embodiment, and the plating module **400** can be configured not to include these members.

(43) With reference to FIG. **3**, inside the plating tank **10**, the membrane module **40** is arranged at a position between the anode **13** and the substrate Wf (a cathode) (specifically, at a position between the anode **13** and the ionically resistive element **14** in this embodiment). Inside the plating tank **10**, a region below a first membrane **41** described later of the membrane module **40** is referred to as an anode chamber **11**, and a region above the first membrane **41** is referred to as the cathode chamber **12**. The above-described anode **13** is arranged in the anode chamber **11**. Details of the membrane

module **40** will be described later.

(44) The substrate holder **20** holds the substrate Wf as the cathode such that a surface to be plated (a lower surface) of the substrate Wf is opposed to the anode **13**. The substrate holder **20** is connected to the rotation mechanism **22**. The rotation mechanism **22** is a mechanism for rotating the substrate holder **20**. The rotation mechanism **22** is connected to the elevating mechanism **24**. The elevating mechanism **24** is supported by a support pillar **26** extending in the vertical direction. The elevating mechanism **24** is a mechanism for moving up and down the substrate holder **20** and the rotation mechanism **22**. The substrate Wf and the anode **13** are electrically connected to an energization device (not illustrated). The energization device is a device for flowing electricity between the substrate Wf and the anode **13** in performing the plating process.

(45) In the plating tank **10**, an anode chamber supply port **16** for supplying the plating solution Ps to the anode chamber **11** and anode chamber discharge ports **17** for discharging the plating solution Ps from the anode chamber **11** to an outside of the plating tank **10** are disposed. The anode chamber supply port **16** according to this embodiment is arranged in the bottom wall **10a** of the plating tank **10** as an example. The anode chamber discharge ports **17** are arranged in the outer peripheral wall **10b** of the plating tank **10** as an example. The anode chamber discharge ports **17** are disposed at two positions in the plating tank **10**. Details of the anode chamber discharge port **17** will be described later.

(46) The plating solution Ps discharged from the anode chamber discharge ports **17** is temporarily accumulated in a reservoir tank: for anode chamber, and then supplied from the anode chamber supply port **16** to the anode chamber **11** again. Details of a circulation aspect of the plating solution Ps will be described in another embodiment (Embodiment 3) described later.

(47) In the plating tank **10**, a supply/drain port **18** for the cathode chamber **12** is disposed. The supply/drain port **18** is a combination of a “supply port of the plating solution Ps for the cathode chamber **12**” and a “drain port of the plating solution Ps for the cathode chamber **12**”.

(48) That is, when the plating solution Ps is supplied to the cathode chamber **12**, the supply/drain port **18** functions as the “supply port of the plating solution Ps for the cathode chamber **12**”, and the plating solution Ps is supplied from the supply/drain port **18** to the cathode chamber **12**. On the other hand, when the plating solution Ps is discharged from the cathode chamber **12**, the supply/drain port **18** functions as the “drain port of the plating solution Ps for the cathode chamber **12**”, and the plating solution Ps in the cathode chamber **12** is discharged from the supply/drain port **18**.

(49) Specifically, a flow passage switching valve (not illustrated) is connected to the supply/drain port **18** according to this embodiment. By switching a flow passage by the flow passage switching valve, the supply/drain port **18** selectively performs supplying the plating solution Ps to the cathode chamber **12** and discharging the plating solution Ps in the cathode chamber **12** to the outside of the plating tank **10**.

(50) FIG. **4** is a schematic diagram for describing details of the supply/drain port **18**. Specifically, in FIG. **4**, a schematic top view of the plating tank **10** is illustrated, and in a part (a part A3) of FIG. **4**, a schematic front view of a peripheral configuration of the supply/drain port **18** is also illustrated. In FIG. **4**, illustration of the ionically resistive element **14**, the electric field adjusting block **30**, and the first support member **43** and a first sealing member **45** that are described later is omitted.

(51) As illustrated in FIG. **4**, the supply/drain port **18** according to this embodiment is disposed in the outer peripheral wall **10b** of the plating tank **10**. The supply/drain port **18** is disposed such that a height (H) from an extending portion **41a** of the first membrane **41** described later to the supply/drain port **18** is within 20 mm. That is, the height (H) may be 0 mm (in this case, the supply/drain port **18** is arranged immediately above the extending portion **41a** of the first membrane **41**), may be 20 mm, or may be an arbitrary value selected from a range larger than 0 mm and smaller than 20 mm.

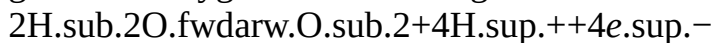
(52) With this configuration, the plating solution Ps in the cathode chamber **12** can be easily discharged from the cathode chamber **12**.

(53) Note that the configuration of the supply/drain port **18** is not limited to the above-described configuration. To give another example, the plating module **400** may individually include the “supply port of the plating solution Ps for the cathode chamber **12**” and the “drain port of the plating solution Ps for the cathode chamber **12**” instead of the supply/drain port **18**.

(54) When the plating process is performed on the substrate Wf first, the rotation mechanism **22** rotates the substrate holder **20** while the elevating mechanism **24** moves the substrate holder **20** downward to immerse the substrate Wf in the plating solution Ps in the plating tank **10** (the plating solution Ps in the cathode chamber **12**). Next, electricity is flowed between the anode **13** and the substrate Wf by the energization device. This forms the plating film on the surface to be plated of the substrate Wf.

(55) In performing the plating process on the substrate Wf, the supply/drain port **18** does not fulfill the function as the “drain port of the plating solution Ps for the cathode chamber **12**”. Specifically, in performing the plating process, the plating solution Ps in the cathode chamber **12** overflows from the upper end of the outer peripheral wall **10b** of the plating tank **10** and is temporarily accumulated in the overflow tank **19**. After completion of the plating process, when the plating solution Ps in the cathode chamber **12** is discharged from the cathode chamber **12** to empty the plating solution Ps out of the cathode chamber **12**, the supply, drain port **18** enters a valve-opening state and functions as the “drain port of the plating solution Ps for the cathode chamber **12**” to discharge the plating solution Ps from the supply/drain port **18**.

(56) In the cup type plating apparatus **1000** as described in this embodiment, gas bubbles Bu (this reference numeral is mentioned in FIG. **13** described later) are possibly generated in the anode chamber **11** for some reason. Specifically, as described in this embodiment, when an insoluble anode is used as the anode **13**, oxygen (O.sub.2) is generated in the anode chamber **11** based on the following reaction equation in performing the plating process (in applying current). In this case, the generated oxygen becomes the gas bubbles Bu.



(57) If a soluble anode is used as the anode **13**, the above reaction equation does not occur. However, for example, when the plating solution Ps is first supplied to the anode chamber **11**, air possibly flows into the anode chamber **11** together with the plating solution Ps. Accordingly, when a soluble anode is used as the anode **13**, the gas bubbles Bu may also be generated in the anode chamber **11**.

(58) As described above, in a case where the gas bubbles Bu are generated in the anode chamber **11**, if the gas bubbles Bu remain entirely on a lower surface of the membrane module **40** (specifically, a lower surface of the second membrane **42** described later), the gas bubbles Bu possibly cut off the electric field. In this case, plating quality of the substrate Wf possibly deteriorates. Therefore, in this embodiment, a technique that will be described in the following is used to deal with such a problem.

(59) FIG. **5** is a schematic exploded perspective view of the membrane module **40**. FIG. **6** is a schematic enlarged cross-sectional view of a part A1 of FIG. **3**. The membrane module **40** according to this embodiment includes the first membrane **41**, the second membrane **42**, the first support member **43** (that is, a “first membrane support member”), a second support member **44** (that is, a “second membrane support member”), the first sealing member **45**, a second sealing member **46**, and a third sealing member **47**. These constituting members of the membrane module **40** are secured to a predetermined position of the outer peripheral wall **10b** of the plating tank **10** (that is, a secured position to which the membrane module **40** is secured) using a fastening member, such as a bolt.

(60) FIG. **7** is a schematic top view of the first membrane **41**. FIG. **8** is a schematic top view of the first support member **43**. FIG. **9** is a schematic top view of the second membrane **42** and the second

support member **44**. FIG. **10** is a cross-sectional view schematically illustrating a cross-sectional surface taken along a line B1-B1 of FIG. **9**. FIG. **11** is a schematic top view of the first sealing member **45**. FIG. **12** is a schematic top view of the second sealing member **46** (or the third sealing member **47**). FIG. **13** is a schematic enlarged cross-sectional view of a part A2 of FIG. **3**.

(61) The first membrane **41** is a membrane configured to allow ion species (which include metal ions) included in the plating solution Ps to pass through the first membrane **41** and suppress passing of a nonionic plating additive included in the plating solution Ps through the first membrane **41**. Specifically, the first membrane **41** has a plurality of fine holes (micropores) (illustration of the micropores is omitted). An average diameter of the plurality of holes is a size of nanometer (that is, a size of 1 nm or more and 999 nm or less). This allows the ion species (which have a size of nanometer) including metal ions to pass through the plurality of micropores of the first membrane **41** while suppressing passing of the nonionic plating additive (which has a size larger than nanometer) through the plurality of micropores of the first membrane **41**. As the first membrane **41**, for example, an ion exchange membrane can be used. Examples of specific product names of the first membrane **41** include Nafion membranes manufactured by The Chemours Company.

(62) As described in this embodiment, by including the first membrane **41** in the plating module **400**, movement of the nonionic plating additive included in the plating solution Ps in the cathode chamber **12** to the anode chamber **11** can be suppressed. This can ensure a reduction in consumption amount of the plating additive in the cathode chamber **12**.

(63) As illustrated in FIG. **7**, the first membrane **41** includes the extending portion **41a** and inclined portions **41b**. The extending portion **41a** extends in the horizontal direction. Specifically, the extending portion **41a** extends in the horizontal direction (the Y-direction as an example) while passing through the center of the anode chamber **11**. The extending portion **41a** is configured of a surface having a predetermined width (a length in the X-direction).

(64) The inclined portions **41b** extend from the extending portion **41a** as a starting point to one side (an X-direction side) and the other side (a -X-direction side) in directions away from the extending portion **41a** and incline so as to be positioned upward as separating from the extending portion **41a**. As a result, the first membrane **41** according to this embodiment has a “V-shaped” appearance shape in front view (when viewed from the Y-direction). An outer edge of the inclined portion **41b** according to this embodiment has an arc shape. Specifically, the outer edge of the inclined portion **41b** has an arc shape in which parts of the outer edge are connected to both ends of the extending portion **41a** (an end portion on a Y-direction side and an end portion on a -Y-direction side). As a result, the first membrane **41** has an approximately circular shape in top view.

(65) To give an example of an inclination angle relative to the horizontal direction of the inclined portions **41b** of the first membrane **41**, for example, a value of two degrees or more can be used as the inclination angle, and specifically, a value of two degrees or more and 45 degrees or less can be used.

(66) As illustrated in FIG. **8**, the first support member **43** is a member for supporting the first membrane **41**. Specifically, the first support member **43** includes a first portion **43a** that supports the extending portion **41a** of the first membrane **41** and a second portion **43b** that supports the outer edges of the inclined portions **41b** of the first membrane **41**. The first portion **43a** extends in the horizontal direction. Specifically, the first portion **43a** extends in the horizontal direction (the Y-direction as an example) while passing through the center of the anode chamber **11**. The second portion **43b** is configured of a circular member and inclines so as to be positioned upward as separating from the first portion **43a**.

(67) The first portion **43a** according to this embodiment is positioned above the first membrane **41** and supports the first membrane **41** from the upper side.

(68) As illustrated in FIG. **5**, the first sealing member **45** is a sealing member that is sandwiched between the first membrane **41** and the first support member **43**. Thus, by arranging the first sealing

member **45** between the first membrane **41** and the first support member **43**, the first membrane **41** and the first support member **43** are in a mutually non-contact state.

(69) As illustrated in FIG. **11**, the first sealing member **45** includes an extending sealing portion **45a** and an outer edge sealing portion **45b**. The extending sealing portion **45a** extends in the horizontal direction and is sandwiched between the extending portion **41a** of the first membrane **41** and the first portion **43a** of the first support member **43**. The outer edge sealing portion **45b** is sandwiched between the outer edges of the inclined portions **41b** of the first membrane **41** and the second portion **43b** of the first support member **43**.

(70) With reference to FIG. **5** and FIG. **6**, the second membrane **42** is arranged at a position below the first membrane **41** and above the anode **13** without contacting the first membrane **41**. A region below the second membrane **42** is referred to as a “first region R1”, and a region above the second membrane **42** and below the first membrane **41** (a region between the second membrane **42** and the first membrane **41**) is referred to as a “second region R2”. The second region R2 allows the plating solution Ps to circulate in this region.

(71) With reference to FIG. **5**, FIG. **6**, FIG. **9**, and FIG. **10**, the second membrane **42** according to this embodiment is bonded to the second support member **44**. Specifically, the second membrane **42** according to this embodiment is bonded to a lower surface of the second support member **44** as an example.

(72) The second membrane **42** is a membrane configured to allow the ion species (ion species including metal ions) included in the plating solution Ps to pass through the second membrane **42** and suppress passing of the gas bubbles Bu through the second membrane **42**. Specifically, the second membrane **42** has a plurality of micropores (illustration of the micropores is omitted). An average diameter of the plurality of micropores is a size of nanometer. This allows the ion species including metal ions to pass through the micropores of the second membrane **42** while suppressing passing of the gas bubbles Bu (which have a size larger than nanometer) through the micropores of the second membrane **42**.

(73) It is preferred that a different kind of membrane from the first membrane **41** is used for the second membrane **42**. For example, the second membrane **42** can differ in material, surface property (such as hydrophobicity and hydrophilicity), surface roughness, dimension and density of the micropores, and the like from the first membrane **41**. As one embodiment, as the first membrane **41**, a membrane having excellent performance of suppressing movement of the plating additive that can be included in the plating solution Ps can be used, and as the second membrane **42**, a membrane having an excellent flow feature of the gas bubbles Bu in which the gas bubbles Bu are difficult to attach can be used. The average diameter of the micropores of the second membrane **42** may have a size larger than the average diameter of the micropores of the first membrane **41**.

(74) Examples of the size of the average diameter of the micropores of the second membrane **42** include a value selected from a range of several tens of nm to several hundreds of nm (to give an example of this, for example, a value selected from a range of 10 nm to 300 nm). The surface roughness of the second membrane **42** is preferably small in a point that the gas bubbles Bu become difficult to attach. It is preferable to be a case where a surface of the second membrane **42** is hydrophilic in a point that the gas bubbles Bu become more difficult to attach than a case where the surface of the second membrane **42** is hydrophobic (generally, the gas bubbles Bu are hydrophobic). Examples of specific product names of the second membrane **42** include “Electrolytic Diaphragm For Plating” manufactured by Yuasa Membrane Systems Co., Ltd.

(75) In the plating module **400** according to this embodiment, two kinds of ion permeable membranes, the first membrane **41** and the second membrane **42**, are used. Depending on the kind of membrane, ion permeability, permeability of an additive, adherability of gas bubbles, and the like are each different, and with only one kind of membrane, it is difficult to fulfill a preferable function in the plating module **400** in some cases. Therefore, in the plating module **400** according

to this embodiment, by using the two kinds of ion permeable membranes having different properties, improvement in the overall function of the plating module **400** can be ensured.

(76) With reference to FIG. **3**, FIG. **9**, and FIG. **10**, the second membrane **42** includes inclined portions **42b** that incline relative to the horizontal direction and incline so as to be positioned upward as heading from the center side of the anode chamber **1110** an outer edge side of the anode chamber **11**.

(77) Specifically, the second membrane **42** according to this embodiment includes the above-described inclined portions **42b** and an extending portion **42a** that extends in the horizontal direction. The inclined portions **42b** extend from the extending portion **42a** as a starting point to one side (the X-direction side) and the other side (the -X-direction side) in directions away from the extending portion **42a** and incline so as to be positioned upward as separating from the extending portion **42a**. As a result, the second membrane **42** according to this embodiment has a “V-shaped” appearance shape in front view (when viewed from the Y-direction).

(78) To give an example of an inclination angle relative to the horizontal direction of the inclined portions **42b** of the second membrane **42**, for example, a value of two degrees or more can be used as the inclination angle, and specifically, a value of two degrees or more and 45 degrees or less can be used.

(79) An outer edge of the inclined portion **42b** according to this embodiment has an arc shape. Specifically, the outer edge of the inclined portion **42b** has an arc shape in which parts of the outer edge are connected to both ends of the extending portion **42a** (an end portion on the Y-direction side and an end portion on the -Y-direction side). As a result, the second membrane **42** has an approximately circular shape in top view. The inclined portions **42b** of the second membrane **42** according to this embodiment are approximately parallel to the inclined portions **41b** of the first membrane **41**.

(80) The extending portion **42a** extends in the horizontal direction (the Y-direction as an example) while passing through the center of the anode chamber **11**. The extending portion **42a** is configured of a surface having a predetermined width (a length in the X-direction). The extending portion **42a** is bonded to a lower surface of a first portion **44a** described later of the second support member **44**.

(81) In the extending portion **42a** of the second membrane **42**, inflow ports **42c** (which are illustrated in, for example, FIG. **6** and FIG. **10**) are disposed for causing the plating solution Ps below the second membrane **42** to flow into the region above the second membrane **42** and below the first membrane **41**. Specifically, a plurality of the inflow ports **42c** according to this embodiment are disposed in the extending direction of the extending portion **42a** of the second membrane **42**.

(82) The dimension of the inflow port **42c** (that is, an opening dimension) is preferably 2 mm or more in the shortest dimension and 15 mm or less in the longest dimension. Specifically, when the inflow port **42c** has, for example, a circular shape, the diameter is preferably 2 mm or more and 15 mm or less. When the inflow port **42c** has, for example, a rectangular shape, the length of a side of the rectangular is preferably 2 mm or more and 15 mm or less. The number of the inflow ports **42c** having such a preferable dimension may be one or plural. The first region R1 and the second region R2 of the anode chamber **11** are fluid-connected by the inflow ports **42c**.

(83) A lower surface of the inclined portion **42b** of the second membrane **42** is preferably smoother than a lower surface of the inclined portion **41b** of the first membrane **41**. In other words, the surface roughness (Ra) of the lower surface of the inclined portion **42b** of the second membrane **42** is preferably smaller than the surface roughness (Ra) of the lower surface of the inclined portion **41b** of the first membrane **41**. With this configuration, the gas bubbles Bu can be effectively moved along the lower surfaces of the inclined portions **42b** of the second membrane **42**. This can effectively suppress deterioration of the plating quality of the substrate Wf due to the gas bubbles Bu.

(84) The second support member **44** is a member for supporting the second membrane **42**.

Specifically, the second support member **44** includes the first portion **44a** that supports the extending portion **42a** of the second membrane **42** and a second portion **44b** that supports the outer edges of the inclined portions **42b** of the second membrane **42**. The first portion **44a** extends in the horizontal direction. Specifically, the first portion **44a** extends in the horizontal direction (the Y-direction as an example) while passing through the center of the anode chamber **11**. The second portion **44b** is configured of a circular member and inclines so as to be positioned upward as separating from the first portion **44a**.

(85) At positions in the first portion **44a** corresponding to the inflow ports **42c** of the second membrane **42**, holes **44c** arranged so as to communicate with the inflow ports **42c** are disposed. This causes the inflow ports **42c** not to be obstructed by the first portion **44a**.

(86) As illustrated in FIG. 5 and FIG. 12, the second sealing member **46** is a sealing member arranged so as to be sandwiched between the first membrane **41** and the second support member **44**. The third sealing member **47** is a sealing member arranged so as to be sandwiched between the second silt member **44** and the secured position of the outer peripheral wall **10b** of the plating tank **10**.

(87) In this embodiment, the shapes of the second sealing member **46** and the third sealing member **47** are identical. Specifically, as illustrated in FIG. 12, the second sealing member **46** and the third sealing member **47** have a circular shape as a whole in top view. The second sealing member **46** is sandwiched between the outer edges of the inclined portions **41b** of the first membrane **41** and the second portion **44b** of the second support member **44**. The third sealing member **47** is sandwiched between the second portion **44b** of the second support member **44** and the secured position of the outer peripheral wall **10b** of the plating tank **10**.

(88) With this embodiment as described above, the second membrane **42** as described above is included, and therefore, as illustrated in FIG. 13, even when the gas bubbles Bu are generated in the anode chamber **11**, the gas bubbles Bu can be moved along the inclined portions **42b** of the second membrane **42** using buoyancy and moved to the outer edge of the second membrane **42**. This can suppress remaining of the gas bubbles Bu generated in the anode chamber **11** entirely on the lower surfaces of the first membrane **41** and the second membrane **42**. As a result, deterioration of the plating quality of the substrate Wf due to the gas bubbles Bu remaining entirely on the lower surfaces of the first membrane **41** and the second membrane **42** can be suppressed.

(89) FIG. 14 is a schematic enlarged view of a part A4 of FIG. 13. With reference to FIG. 13 and FIG. 14, in the outer peripheral wall **10b** of the plating tank **10**, a housing groove **50** is disposed. The housing groove **50** is formed in the outer peripheral wall **10b** of the plating tank **10** so as to be along the outer edges of the inclined portions **42b** of the second membrane **42**. Specifically, the housing groove **50** according to this embodiment is formed on the whole circumference in the circumferential direction of the outer peripheral wall **10b** so as to be along the outer edges of the inclined portions **42b** of the second membrane **42**.

(90) The housing groove **50** is configured to temporarily house the gas bubbles Bu moved to the outer edges of the inclined portions **42b** of the second membrane **42** and configured to cause the plating solution Ps in the first region R1 and the plating solution Ps in the second region R2 to join together in the housing groove **50**.

(91) Specifically, as illustrated in FIG. 14, the housing groove **50** according to this embodiment is formed such that an upper side groove wall **50a** is positioned above the second membrane **42**, and a lower side groove wall **50b** opposed to the upper side groove wall **50a** is positioned below the second membrane **42**. This allows the housing groove **50** to effectively house the gas bubbles Bu moved to the outer edges of the inclined portions **42b** along the inclined portions **42b** of the second membrane **42** and can facilitate joining the plating solution Ps in the first region R1 and the second region R2 together in the housing groove **50**.

(92) While the distance between the upper side groove wall **50a** and the lower side groove wall **50b** (that is, a groove width W1) is not particularly limited, in this embodiment, the distance is set to a

value selected from a range of 2 mm or more and 30 mm or less as an example.

(93) With reference to FIG. 13, the housing groove 50 communicates with the anode chamber discharge ports 17 described later through communication passages 51. Specifically, the communication passage 51 communicates between an upper end of the housing groove 50 and an upstream end of the anode chamber discharge port 17.

(94) The anode chamber discharge port 17 communicates with the housing groove 50 via the communication passage 51 disposed in the outer peripheral wall 10b of the plating tank 10. The anode chamber discharge port 17 is configured to suction the plating solution Ps in the first region R1 and the plating solution Ps in the second region R2 together with the gas bubbles Bu housed in the housing groove 50 and discharge them to the outside of the plating tank 10.

(95) Specifically, the anode chamber discharge port 17 according to this embodiment communicates with a part positioned on the uppermost side of the housing groove 50 via the communication passage 51 disposed in the outer peripheral wall 10b of the plating tank 10. At a part of the second portion 44b of the second support member 44, a groove 44d (or a hole may be applied) is disposed for causing the plating solution Ps in the second region R2 flowing along an upper surface of the second membrane 42 to flow into the communication passage 51. The plating solution Ps in the first region R1 and the plating solution Ps in the second region R2 flow along the second membrane 42, then join together and flow into the communication passages 51, and next, are discharged from the anode chamber discharge ports 17. Note that the total of two anode chamber discharge ports 17 according to this embodiment are disposed.

(96) With this embodiment, the gas bubbles Bu moved to the outer edges of the inclined portions 42b of the second membrane 42 can be temporarily housed in the housing groove 50, and the housed gas bubbles Bu can be discharged from the anode chamber discharge ports 17 to the outside of the plating tank 10 together with the plating solution Ps in the first region R1 and the second region R2. This can effectively suppress remaining of the gas bubbles Bu on the lower surface of the second membrane 42.

(97) With this embodiment, the gas bubbles Bu are temporarily housed in the housing groove 50, and therefore, a plurality of small gas bubbles Bu can be joined and made into large gas bubbles Bu in the housing groove 50. This can make it easier to discharge the gas bubbles Bu from the anode chamber discharge ports 17.

(98) As illustrated in FIG. 13, the communication passage 51 may be configured such that the cross-sectional area of the communication passage 51 decreases as heading to the downstream side. Since this configuration makes it easier for the gas bubbles Bu to temporarily remain in the housing groove 50, in the housing groove 50, the plurality of small gas bubbles Bu can be effectively joined and made into the large gas bubbles Bu. This can effectively discharge the gas bubbles Bu from the anode chamber discharge ports 17.

Embodiment 2

(99) Subsequently, Embodiment 2 of the present invention will be described. In the following description, similar reference numerals are attached to configurations similar to those in Embodiment 1 described above, and the description will be omitted (which also applies to Embodiment 3 described later). FIG. 15 is a cross-sectional view schematically illustrating a peripheral configuration of a second membrane 42 of a plating apparatus 1000A according to this embodiment. In FIG. 15, illustration of the second support member 44 and the like is omitted.

(100) The plating apparatus 1000A according to this embodiment is different from the plating apparatus 1000 according to Embodiment 1 described above in a point that a suppressing member 60 configured to suppress flowing of the gas bubbles Bu present in the first region R1 of the anode chamber 11 into the inflow ports 42c of the second membrane 42 is further included.

(101) Specifically, the suppressing member 60 according to this embodiment includes a suppressing plate 61 configured of a plate member arranged below the inflow ports 42c of the second membrane 42 and extending in the horizontal direction. The suppressing plate 61 according

to this embodiment is configured of the plate member having a larger area than the inflow ports **42c**. This entirely hides the inflow ports **42c** by the suppressing plate **61** when the suppressing plate **61** is viewed from the lower side. For example, the position of the suppressing plate **61** may be secured by being connected to the second support member **44** via a connecting member (not illustrated).

(102) With this embodiment, flowing of the gas bubbles Bu in the first region R1 into the inflow ports **42c** can be suppressed by the above-described suppressing member **60**. Specifically, the gas bubbles Bu moving up toward the inflow ports **42c** contact a lower surface of the suppressing plate **61**, thereby allowing suppressing flowing of the gas bubbles Bu into the inflow ports **42c**. This can suppress flowing of the gas bubbles Bu in the first region R1 into the second region R2 from the inflow ports **42c**.

Modification of Embodiment 2

(103) FIG. **16** is a cross-sectional view schematically illustrating a peripheral configuration of a second membrane **42** of a plating apparatus **1000B** according to a modification of Embodiment 2. In FIG. **16**, illustration of the second support member **44** and the like is omitted. The plating apparatus **1000B** according to this modification includes a suppressing member **60B** instead of the suppressing member **60**.

(104) The suppressing member **60B** includes a tubular member **62** and a coupling member **63**. The tubular member **62** is configured of a tubular member arranged below the inflow ports **42c** of the second membrane **42** and extending in the horizontal direction (a direction of the X-axis in FIG. **16**). The coupling member **63** is a tubular member configured to couple an inside of the tubular member **62** to the inflow ports **42c**. As exemplified in FIG. **16**, a lower end of the coupling member **63** may pass through a tube side wall of the tubular member **62** and project to the inside of the tubular member **62**. The plating solution Ps in the anode chamber **11** passes through the inside of the tubular member **62** and an inside of the coupling member **63** in this order, and afterwards, flows into the inflow ports **42c**.

(105) With this modification, the gas bubbles Bu moving up toward the inflow ports **42c** contact a lower surface of the tubular member **62** (a lower surface of a tube outer wall) and an upper surface of a tube inner wall, thereby allowing suppressing flowing of the gas bubbles Bu into the inflow ports **42c**. This can suppress flowing of the gas bubbles Bu in the first region R1 into the second region R2 from the inflow ports **42c**.

(106) Additionally, with this modification, as described above, a lower end of the coupling member **63** projects to the inside of the tubular member **62**. Therefore, even if the gas bubbles Bu invade the inside of the tubular member **62**, the gas bubbles Bu contact a part of the coupling member **63** projecting to the inside of the tubular member **62**, thereby allowing suppressing invasion of the gas bubbles Bu to the inside of the coupling member **63**. This can effectively suppress flowing of the gas bubbles Bu inside the tubular member **62** into the second region R2.

Embodiment 3

(107) Subsequently, a plating apparatus **10000** according to Embodiment 3 of the present invention will be described. FIG. **17** is a schematic diagram for describing a plating solution circulation module **70** included in the plating apparatus **10000** according to this embodiment. Note that the plating solution circulation module **70** of FIG. **17** may be applied to the plating module **400** according to Embodiment 1 and may be applied to the plating module **400** according to Embodiment 2.

(108) The plating solution circulation module **70** according to this embodiment mainly includes reservoir tanks **72a** and **72b**, pumps **73a** and **73b**, pressure gauges **74a** and **74b**, a pressure regulating valve **75**, flow passages **80a**, **80b**, **80c**, and **80d**, and the like. The operation of the plating solution circulation module **70** is controlled by the control module **800**. In this embodiment, of the control function of the control module **800**, a functional portion that controls the plating solution circulation module **70** is included in a part of constituent elements of the plating solution

circulation module **70**.

(109) The control module **800** that controls the plating solution circulation module **70** includes a processor **801** and a non-transitory storage device **802**. The storage device **802** stores programs, data, and the like. In the control module **800**, the processor **801** controls the plating solution circulation module **70** based on a command of the program stored in the storage device **802**.

(110) The reservoir tank **72a** is a tank for temporarily accumulating the plating solution Ps for the anode chamber **11**. That is, the reservoir tank **72a** is a “reservoir tank for the anode chamber **11**”. The reservoir tank **72b** is a tank configured to temporarily accumulate the plating solution Ps for the cathode chamber **12**. That is, the reservoir tank **72b** is a “reservoir tank for the cathode chamber **12**”.

(111) The flow passage **80a** is a flow passage for circulating the plating solution Ps in the reservoir tank **72a** to the anode chamber **11**. The flow passage **80b** is a flow passage for circulating (returning) the plating solution Ps in the anode chamber **11** to the reservoir tank **72a**. The flow passage **80c** is a flow passage for circulating the plating solution Ps in the reservoir tank **72b** to the cathode chamber **12**. The flow passage **80d** is a flow passage for returning the plating solution Ps that has overflowed from the cathode chamber **12** and flowed into the overflow tank **19** to the reservoir tank **72b** from the overflow tank **19**.

(112) The pump **73a** is a pump for pressure-feeding the plating solution Ps in the reservoir tank **72a** toward the anode chamber **11**. The pump **73a** according to this embodiment is arranged at a position in the middle of the flow passage **80a**. The pump **73b** is a pump for pressure-feeding the plating solution Ps in the reservoir tank **72b** toward the cathode chamber **12**. The pump **73b** according to this embodiment is arranged at a position in the middle of the flow passage **80c**. The operations of the pump **73b** and the pump **73a** are controlled by the control module **800**.

(113) The pressure gauge **74a** detects a pressure in the anode chamber **11** (specifically, a pressure of the plating solution Ps in the anode chamber **11**) and transmits the detection result to the control module **800**. The pressure gauge **74b** detects a pressure in the cathode chamber **12** (specifically, a pressure of the plating solution Ps in the cathode chamber **12**) and transmits the detection result to the control module **800**.

(114) At least in performing the plating process on the substrate Wf, the plating solution circulation module **70** circulates the plating solution Ps between the anode chamber **11** and the reservoir tank **72a** and circulates the plating solution Ps between the cathode chamber **12** and the reservoir tank **72b**.

(115) Specifically, the control module **800** according to this embodiment activates the pump **73a** and the pump **73b** at least in performing the plating process. By activating the pump **73a**, the plating solution Ps in the reservoir tank **72a** circulates through the flow passage **80a** and is supplied to the anode chamber **11**. The plating solution Ps discharged from the anode chamber **11** circulates through the flow passage **80b** and returns to the reservoir tank **72a**. By activating the pump **73b**, the plating solution Ps in the reservoir tank **72b** circulates through the flow passage **80c** and is supplied to the cathode chamber **12**. The plating solution Ps that has overflowed from the cathode chamber **12** and flowed into the overflow tank **19** circulates through the flow passage **80d** and returns to the reservoir tank **72b**.

(116) The pressure regulating valve **75** is arranged at a position in the middle of the flow passage **80b**. The pressure regulating valve **75** regulates the pressure (Pa) in the anode chamber **11** by regulating a pressure (Pa) of the plating solution Ps circulating through the flow passage **80b**. Specifically, when the pressure regulating valve **75** increases the pressure of the plating solution Ps circulating through the flow passage **80b**, the pressure in the anode chamber **11** increases. On the other hand, when the pressure regulating valve **75** lowers the pressure of the plating solution Ps circulating through the flow passage **80b**, the pressure in the anode chamber **11** also lowers.

(117) The pressure regulating valve **75** according to this embodiment regulates the pressure in the anode chamber **11** such that the pressure in the anode chamber **11** has a value identical to a value of

the pressure in the cathode chamber **12**. In this case, in performing the plating process, the pump **73a** does not operate by feedbacking the pressure in the anode chamber **11** and the pressure in the cathode chamber **12**, but continues to pressure-feed the plating solution Ps at a constant rotational speed.

(118) With this configuration, the pressure in the anode chamber **11** can be regulated to be the value identical to the value of the pressure in the cathode chamber **12** in performing the plating process with a simple configuration of regulation by the pressure regulating valve **75**.

(119) Usually, in performing the plating process, the pressure in the cathode chamber **12** is a pressure (a constant value) slightly higher than the atmospheric pressure. In view of this, the plating solution circulation module **70** can be configured not to include the pressure gauge **74b**. Specifically, in this case, it is only necessary to use a preset predetermined pressure as the pressure in the cathode chamber **12**.

(120) Although the embodiments of the present invention have been described in detail above, the present invention is not limited to such specific embodiments, and further various kinds of variants and modifications are possible within the scope of the present invention described in the claims.

REFERENCE SIGNS LIST

(121) **10** . . . plating tank **10a** . . . bottom wall **10b** . . . outer peripheral wall **11** . . . anode chamber **12** . . . cathode chamber **13** . . . anode **14** . . . ionically resistive element **17** . . . anode chamber discharge port **18** . . . supply/drain port (“drain port”) **20** . . . substrate holder **30** . . . electric field adjusting block **40** . . . membrane module **41** . . . first membrane **41a** . . . extending portion **41b** . . . inclined portion **42** . . . second membrane **42a** . . . extending portion **42b** . . . inclined portion **42c** . . . inflow port **43** . . . first support member (“first membrane support member”) **44** . . . second support member (“second membrane support member”) **50** . . . housing groove **60** . . . suppressing member **61** . . . suppressing plate **62** . . . tubular member **63** . . . coupling member **70** . . . plating solution circulation module **72a**, **72b** . . . reservoir tank **75** . . . pressure regulating valve **80a** to **80d** . . . flow passage **800** . . . control module **1000** . . . plating apparatus Wf . . . substrate Ps . . . plating solution Bu . . . gas bubbles **R1** . . . first region **R2** . . . second region

Claims

1. A plating apparatus comprising: a plating tank having a bottom wall and an outer peripheral wall extending upward from an outer edge of the bottom wall, the plating tank being configured to accumulate a plating solution and have an anode arranged therein; a substrate holder arranged above the anode, the substrate holder being configured to hold a substrate as a cathode such that the substrate is opposed to the anode; and a membrane module arranged above the anode and below the substrate, wherein the membrane module includes a first membrane configured to partition an inside of the plating tank into an anode chamber and a cathode chamber below the anode chamber, and a second membrane arranged at a position below the first membrane and above the anode without contacting the first membrane, and the second membrane has an inflow port for causing a plating solution in a first region below the second membrane to flow into a second region above the second membrane and below the first membrane, and an inclined portion inclining relative to a horizontal direction and inclining so as to be positioned upward as heading from a center side of the anode chamber to an outer edge side of the anode chamber.

2. The plating apparatus according to claim 1, wherein the first membrane includes an extending portion extending in the horizontal direction, and inclined portions extending from the extending portion as a starting point to one side and another side in a direction away from the extending portion and inclining so as to be positioned upward as separating from the extending portion.

3. The plating apparatus according to claim 2, wherein the outer peripheral wall of the plating tank is provided with a drain port for discharging a plating solution in the cathode chamber from the cathode chamber, and the drain port is disposed such that a height from the extending portion of the

first membrane to the drain port is within 20 mm.

4. The plating apparatus according to claim 1, wherein the membrane module further includes a second membrane support member configured to support the second membrane.

5. The plating apparatus according to claim 1, wherein the membrane module further includes a first membrane support member configured to support the first membrane.

6. The plating apparatus according to claim 1, further comprising a housing groove formed in the outer peripheral wall of the plating tank so as to be along an outer edge of the inclined portion of the second membrane, wherein the housing groove is configured to temporarily house gas bubbles moved to the outer edge of the inclined portion of the second membrane and configured to cause a plating solution in the first region and a plating solution in the second region to join together in the housing groove, and the plating apparatus further includes an anode chamber discharge port communicating with the housing groove, the anode chamber discharge port being configured to suction the gas bubbles housed in the housing groove together with a plating solution flowing through the housing groove and discharge the gas bubbles and the plating solution to an outside of the plating tank.

7. The plating apparatus according to claim 1, further comprising: an ionically resistive element arranged below the substrate in the cathode chamber; and a ring-shaped electric field adjusting block for adjusting an electric field in the cathode chamber, the electric field adjusting block being arranged below the ionically resistive element in the cathode chamber and above the membrane module, wherein the ionically resistive element is provided with a plurality of through holes disposed so as to pass through a lower surface and an upper surface of the ionically resistive element, and the electric field adjusting block has an inner diameter smaller than an outer diameter of a punching area as an area where the plurality of through holes are disposed in the ionically resistive element.

8. The plating apparatus according to claim 1, further comprising a suppressing member configured to suppress flowing of gas bubbles in the first region into the inflow port.

9. The plating apparatus according to claim 8, wherein the suppressing member includes a suppressing plate arranged below the inflow port of the second membrane and extending in a horizontal direction.

10. The plating apparatus according to claim 8, wherein the suppressing member includes: a tubular member arranged below the inflow port of the second membrane and extending in a horizontal direction; and a coupling member configured to couple an inside of the tubular member to the inflow port.

11. The plating apparatus according to claim 1, further comprising a plating solution circulation module configured to circulate a plating solution between the anode chamber and a reservoir tank for anode chamber and circulate a plating solution between the cathode chamber and a reservoir tank for cathode chamber in performing a plating process on the substrate.

12. The plating apparatus according to claim 11, wherein the plating solution circulation module includes a pressure regulating valve arranged in a flow passage configured to circulate a plating solution in the anode chamber to the reservoir tank for anode chamber, the pressure regulating valve being configured to regulate a pressure in the anode chamber such that the pressure in the anode chamber has a value identical to a value of a pressure in the cathode chamber.
